

THE RIGHT HAND OF THE LORD: THE POWER OF THE ONE TRUE GOD

Key Verse: *“The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.” — Psalm 118:16 (KJV)*

We gather today to consider a phrase that appears throughout the Holy Scriptures—the “right hand of God.” To many in mainstream Christianity, this phrase is understood to imply a distinction of persons within the Godhead, as though the Father sits upon a throne and the Son sits beside Him at His right hand. But I declare unto you this day, upon the authority of God’s Word, that such a reading does violence to the plain testimony of Scripture. The right hand of God is not a second person beside God—it is the power of the One True God Himself in operation. Let us search the Scriptures together and see what the Lord hath spoken concerning His right hand.

I. The Hebrew Word and Its Meaning

Before we proceed further, it is profitable for us to understand the very word that the Holy Spirit inspired in the original tongue. The Hebrew word for “right hand” is yamin (יָמִין, Strong's H3225). This word appears some 137 times in the Old Testament and is found in all periods of biblical Hebrew. It comes from a primitive root meaning “to be firm” or “to be right-handed”. Now observe this well, beloved: yamin denotes the right hand or side of a person or object “as the stronger and more dexterous”. It is the hand of strength, the hand of skill, the hand of preeminence. In Semitic culture generally, the right hand is connected with success and prosperity. The right hand was the hand by which oaths were sworn; indeed, in Arabic, the same root gives us the word for an oath.

Why is this significant? Because when the Hebrew Scriptures speak of the “right hand of the LORD,” they are not speaking of a second being or a separate person. They are speaking of that which is stronger, that which is firm, that which is preeminent. The right hand of the LORD is the LORD’s own strength, His own firmness, His own supremacy. It is the hand that does valiantly because it is His hand—not another’s. The Jewish commentator Rav Hirsch, writing on Exodus 15:6, explains that yamin, the Right Hand of God, is that which “grants help to those threatened”. He further observes that “the idea that the helping, salvation-bringing power of God lies in His Right Hand ... has its source deep in the Jewish

conception of God”. The Right Hand of God is the saving, delivering power of the One God—not a distinction within God, but the very operation of His power on behalf of His people.

II. The Right Hand in the Old Testament: The Power of God Alone

From the very beginning of Israel’s deliverance, the right hand of the Lord is proclaimed as the instrument of God’s own power—not a separate being, but the manifestation of the One God acting on behalf of His people. When Moses and the children of Israel sang their song of triumph after crossing the Red Sea, they declared: “Thy right hand, O LORD, is become glorious in power: thy right hand, O LORD, hath dashed in pieces the enemy” (Exodus 15:6). Observe carefully, beloved: it is the right hand of the LORD—Yahweh Himself—that does these mighty works. The right hand is not another person; it is the LORD’s own power, His own strength, His own outstretched arm of deliverance. The repetition of “thy right hand, O LORD” emphasizes that this is the action of the one and only God. In Hebrew culture, the right hand symbolizes strength, skill, and supremacy; and here it is ascribed wholly to Yahweh.

The psalmist echoes this truth with great clarity: “The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly” (Psalm 118:16). Three times in this psalm the right hand of the LORD is mentioned, and each time it is identified as the LORD’s own right hand—His power, His victory, His salvation. The psalmist does not say “the right hand of the Father” or “the right hand beside God”—he says “the right hand of the LORD.” It is the LORD Himself who is exalted; it is the LORD Himself who does valiantly. Consider also Psalm 89:13: “Thou hast a mighty arm: strong is thy hand, and high is thy right hand.” Here the right hand is explicitly linked with God’s arm and hand—all metaphors for His sovereign power. The psalmist uses the right hand to symbolize God’s “activities, especially his exploits in war”. The right hand of the Lord is not a distinct person but a figure of speech representing God’s omnipotence. As the psalmist declares in Psalm 16:8, “I have set the LORD always before me: because he is at my right hand, I shall not be moved.” Here the psalmist speaks of the LORD being at his right hand—a metaphor for divine protection. Would anyone suggest this means the LORD is literally standing to the right of David? No! It is a figure of speech.

III. The Right Hand as Metaphor, Not Location

We must understand, beloved, that when Scripture speaks of God's right hand, it speaks in the language of men. God is a Spirit (John 4:24) and hath not hands as men have hands. The psalmist himself declares: "He that planted the ear, shall he not hear? he that formed the eye, shall he not see?" (Psalm 94:9). By the same reasoning, He that hath no bodily form hath no literal right hand. The right hand of God is a metaphor—a figure of speech—that conveys divine power, authority, favor, and salvation. As one commentator rightly observes: "God does not have a right hand. This is a biblical metaphor (anthropomorphic) of power, authority, and preeminence". Indeed, in Hebrew thought, body parts are perceived as dynamic and symbolize certain abilities. God's hand, arm, or right hand stand for His might and agency. These are not literal descriptions of God's physical form but inspired figures of speech that help us comprehend His mighty works.

When the psalmist says, "The LORD hath sworn by his right hand, and by the arm of his strength" (Isaiah 62:8), he is using the language of human oath-taking to describe God's solemn promise. God swears by His own power—by Himself—because there is none greater (Hebrews 6:13). The right hand and the arm of strength are not distinct beings; they are poetic expressions of God's own invincible might. This is confirmed by the prophet Isaiah, who declares: "I have covered thee in the shadow of mine hand" (Isaiah 51:16). Does God have a literal hand? No—it is a metaphor for His protection. Likewise, when we read of God's right hand, we must understand it as a metaphor for His power and authority.

IV. The Right Hand in the New Testament: Christ and the Power of God

Now we come to the New Testament, where the phrase "right hand of God" is applied to our Lord Jesus Christ. But here also we must be careful to understand Scripture as Scripture interprets itself—not through the lens of later creeds, but through the plain meaning of God's Word. The apostle Peter, preaching on the day of Pentecost, declares: "Therefore being by the right hand of God exalted, and having received of the Father the promise of the Holy Ghost, he hath shed forth this, which ye now see and hear" (Acts 2:33). Notice the language: Jesus is "by the right hand of God exalted." The right hand is the means of exaltation—it is God's power that raised Him up. The verse does not say Jesus sits beside God as a separate person; it says He was exalted by the right hand of God. The right hand is the power of God in action.

Peter then quotes Psalm 110:1: “The LORD said unto my Lord, Sit thou on my right hand, until I make thy foes thy footstool.” Here we must understand this in light of the One God doctrine. David, speaking by the Spirit, calls his descendant “my Lord”—a prophecy of the Messiah. The Father—the One God in His eternal plan—speaks to the Son (the same One God manifested in flesh) and says, “Sit thou on my right hand.” But what is this right hand? It is the position of honor, power, and authority. As one commentator explains, this is “a figurative phrase, and expressive of the exaltation, dignity, power, and authority of the Messiah”. To be raised to the right hand of a king was significant of favor, trust, and power. In other words, for Jesus to be “at the right hand of God” means that He has been given all power and authority. It does not mean there are two persons sitting side by side in heaven. It means that the One God, who was manifested in the flesh as Jesus Christ, now exercises His sovereign authority through the glorified ministry of His Son.

V. The Beauty and Mystery of the Right Hand Revealed in Jesus Christ

Now, let us pause and behold the profound beauty and sacred mystery of why this very expression—the right hand of the Lord—is specifically applied to our Lord Jesus Christ. The right hand of God was never meant to be an abstract, distant force; it was always the personal, redeeming action of the Living God. But the mystery of godliness is great: God was manifest in the flesh (1 Timothy 3:16). Therefore, the beautiful truth is that Jesus Christ is that right hand of God made visible, tangible, and accessible to humanity. Consider the prophet’s piercing question: “Who hath believed our report? and to whom is the arm of the LORD revealed?” (Isaiah 53:1). The “arm of the LORD”—which in Hebrew poetry is a direct synonym for His right hand—is not revealed as a bolt of lightning or a pillar of fire alone, but ultimately as the suffering servant, Jesus. The beauty lies in the condescension: the same firm, dexterous, and omnipotent yamin that stretched out the heavens and laid the foundations of the earth, that same power, was wrapped in swaddling clothes and laid in a manger. It walked the dusty roads of Galilee, touched the lepers, opened the eyes of the blind, and broke the bread for the multitudes. The apostle Paul unveils this wonder, declaring: “For in him dwelleth all the fulness of the Godhead bodily” (Colossians 2:9). Therefore, Jesus is not a secondary agent sitting beside the power; He is the Power itself in flesh —the fullness of the One God operating in flesh.

The mystery deepens in its loveliness when we realize that the right hand signifies action toward humanity. In the Old Testament, the right hand of God was a terrifying force against Egypt and a mighty shield for Israel. But in Jesus, that same right hand becomes a healing touch, a forgiving word, and a sacrificial death. When Jesus stretched out His hands upon the cross, He was literally stretching forth the right hand of God to embrace the world with salvation. And when He rose again and ascended, He did not go to sit next to the power; He went to sit as the power—the right hand of the Majesty on high (Hebrews 1:3)—exercising all authority in heaven and earth. The beauty of this revelation is that we do not need to reach through the heavens to grasp an abstract force; we look unto Jesus, and in Him, we find the whole strength of the Almighty reaching down to save, uphold, and intercede for us. The right hand is not beside God; in Jesus, the right hand is God come down to lift us up. This is the beautiful mystery: God’s power has a name, and that name is Jesus.

VI. The Right Hand Is the Power of the One God

The epistle to the Hebrews declares: “Who being the brightness of his glory, and the express image of his person, and upholding all things by the word of his power, when he had by himself purged our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high” (Hebrews 1:3). Here we see that Christ is the “brightness of his glory” and the “express image of his person”—not a separate person, but the very manifestation of the One God. When He sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high, He sat down in the place of supreme authority—the authority that belongs to God alone. Similarly, Hebrews 10:12 tells us: “But this man, after he had offered one sacrifice for sins for ever, sat down on the right hand of God.” The right hand of God is the place of divine authority. Jesus, being God manifested in the flesh, has all authority in heaven and in earth (Matthew 28:18). The right hand of God is not a location distinct from God; it is the position of God’s own sovereign power.

Stephen, in his vision, “looked up stedfastly into heaven, and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God” (Acts 7:55). He saw the glory of God, and he saw Jesus—the same One God—standing in the position of divine authority. This is not a vision of two Gods; it is a vision of the One God who is both transcendent (the glory of God) and manifest (Jesus).

VII. The Unity of God in the Right Hand

The testimony of Scripture is clear: “Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God is one LORD” (Deuteronomy 6:4). There is one God, and there is none else. The right hand of God is not a second person; it is the power of the One God. When Jesus said to the high priest, “Hereafter shall ye see the Son of man sitting on the right hand of power” (Matthew 26:64), He was identifying Himself with divine authority. The “power” is God—the One God. Sitting on the right hand of power means sharing in and exercising the very power of God. When Paul writes, “Who is he that condemneth? It is Christ that died, yea rather, that is risen again, who is even at the right hand of God, who also maketh intercession for us” (Romans 8:34), he is declaring that Christ, the One God manifested in flesh, now exercises divine authority and makes intercession for His people. The right hand is not a person; it is the position and power of God. And when Paul exhorts us: “If ye then be risen with Christ, seek those things which are above, where Christ sitteth on the right hand of God” (Colossians 3:1), he is calling us to set our affections on things above—on the power and authority of the One God who has saved us.

Therefore, let us reject the notion that the right hand of God represents a second person in the Godhead. This is a tradition of men that contradicts the plain teaching of Scripture. The right hand of the Lord is the power of the One True God—the same God who delivered Israel from Egypt, who spoke through the prophets, and who was manifested in the flesh as Jesus Christ for our salvation. “The right hand of the LORD is exalted: the right hand of the LORD doeth valiantly.” This is the testimony of the psalmist, and it is our testimony today. The right hand of the Lord is not a separate being—it is the Lord Himself in His power, His glory, and His salvation. There is one God, and His right hand is His own mighty power, working salvation for all who believe. Let us worship the One True God—Father, Son, and Holy Spirit as manifestations of the same eternal Being—and let us trust in His right hand of power. For He alone is God, and there is none else. Amen.